temple reached the same destination as the ones offered in our mosque. I only wondered whether Jal aluddin had any other special connection to God. Jal aluddin's schooling had been limited, principal y because of his family's straitened circumstances. This may have been the reason why he always encouraged me to excel in my studies and enjoyed my success vicariously. Never did I find the slightest trace of resentment in Jal aluddin for his deprivation. Rather, he was always ful of gratitude for whatever life had chosen to give him.

Incidental y, at the time I speak of, he was the only person on the entire island who could write English. He wrote letters for almost anybody in need, be they letters of application or otherwise. Nobody of my acquaintance, either in my family or in the neighbourhood even had Jal aluddin's level of education or any links of consequence with the outside world. Jal aluddin always spoke to me about educated people, of scientific discoveries, of contemporary literature, and of the achievements of medical science. It was he who made me aware of a "brave, new world" beyond our narrow confines.

In the humble environs of my boyhood, books were a